

BACKTRACK: review and revisions

The story a judge should understand

A learner is stuck on today's lesson and does not know what to review. BACKTRACK checks a useful earlier step, connects that step to Khan material, and brings the learner back to a fresh version of the original task. The proposed school pilot asks whether that return holds a week or two later.

The first version relied too heavily on the GPS metaphor. A judge could remember the animated route without understanding the learner's problem. The opening now says "Stuck on one step. Lost in whole lessons." Slide 2 shows how the search itself can consume a study session. The pitch uses short study windows as a design concern; it does not invent an attention-span statistic. The next slide uses one left-to-right example: today's quadratic, a possible earlier gap, and the instruction to check what to work on first.

What the visual review changed

The earlier route drawings had small labels and several unlabeled circles. They could look like performance charts without axes or a clear reading order. The final slide system follows a consistent reading order: headline, central visual, takeaway. The learning loop is a single numbered flow. The recovery choices use two horizontal lanes. Decorative curved route drawings were removed from the slides after the Canva import broke their continuity. The comparison uses two labelled practice conditions leading to the same assessments.

The website's route panel now uses a vertical roadmap with readable labels beside each stop. The current step is highlighted and marked "You're here." The goal stays at the end. Selecting a stop explains its purpose in one sentence. Mobile uses the same labelled structure rather than shrinking a wide desktop drawing.

The mathematical graphs have visible scales, larger plotting areas, directional axis labels, and a highlighted starting x-value. Asking for a hint adds a reading guide to the graph and records the answer as assisted. This connects the explanation to the actual mathematical task.

The presentation uses native DM Sans regular and bold, thin native Canva separators, a white paper texture, teal for the route, and violet for the demo action. The Canva references informed the spacing and contrast; the final layouts were rebuilt after the user found the earlier split compositions confusing. Labels and figures stay aligned to the same reading direction. The editable source preserves separate text, shapes, and budget cells.

A reason to try the demo

Slide 7 is entirely an invitation. Its button and visible URL are clickable, and the QR code opens the same professional demo destination. A small note says that the sample routes help the audience picture BACKTRACK and that the full product remains in development.

The /demo page starts immediately with one equation and two clickable wrong answers. Choosing 3 and 4 points to signs and solutions; choosing 2 and 6 points to factor pairs. Replay makes that contrast easy to see. The separate learner flow offers five destinations: quadratics, equations with brackets, fractions, ratios, and graphs. The product does not ask judges to read the presentation again.

The learning stop

The learning stop now contains one idea, a worked example, and an opportunity to try it. Official Khan videos use verified focused segments where available, with a Continue watching option. Extended Khan exercises remain optional links.

Actual embedded Khan video playback was verified in Chrome. The in-app browser did not render the third-party player, so that browser alone was not treated as proof of a broken embed. The default local repair stays usable without video. Continue watching removes the segment end bound and starts where the focused clip ends.

Guided examples are excluded from subsequent independent checks, including after a pause or reload. A resource open does not pass a step. Two fresh unassisted answers support the route decision.

How to explain the proposal

Show the difficulty first. Demonstrate one route change, then one focused learning stop. Explain the fresh return task. For the pilot, use the plain-language question on slide 8: can the learner still do it next week?

The comparison matters because adaptive learning already exists. The useful question is whether this recovery routine makes Khan practice more effective and manageable for the selected school goals. The research and Q&A address ALEKS and Gemini. The pitch concentrates on the learner's experience and the opportunity to make useful Khan practice easier to find.

The evaluation, budget, and school responsibilities remain detailed in the supporting documents. Keep the spoken pitch centred on what the learner does and what the school will measure. Explain terms such as retained reentry once, using the plain-language example.

The creative mechanism and potential

The clearest creative feature is the wrong-turn clue: the same wrong score can point to different starting checks. The interface explains why, offers the matching short repair, then requires fresh answers. This is the concrete distinction that the earlier version failed to show. The route itself also becomes the reward. Demonstrating a step removes its review. Repairing a gap changes what the learner can do next. A later visit keeps prior progress and checks what remains useful. This has more substance than a decorative progress counter because the learner's actions change the learning sequence.

The judge pass led to a new working clue mechanism and a one-click comparison demo, alongside slides that make the mechanism explicit. The demo invitation now tells the audience which action reveals a route change. The comparison labels are centred, and the problem slide uses one clear question instead of repeating the word review.

My assessment of the concept is positive: the need is recognisable, the response can be demonstrated, Khan supplies the learning resources, and the pattern can grow through further destinations. I would see credible winning potential in the mechanism and its reach. The revised pitch should earn that attention through the visible learner journey rather than a promise of being unlike every existing tool.

Final review record

The final handoff records the completed software checks, document validation, deployment, and Drive updates. Keep that record separate from the application deck. Rehearse the final PDF and the live route together before presenting.